



Self-Registration Flow

How new users sign up for the training platform

Introduction

We're adding a public sign-up page to the training platform so new users can create their own account, instead of having to wait for an admin to invite them. This document explains who can register, what they'll see, and what happens after they sign up.

There are **three ways** someone can sign up. The form chooses the right path automatically based on a single question at the top of the page: *How are you registering today?*

At a glance

1. Joining an organisation that's already on the platform — instant access.
2. Setting up a new school or business — needs charity admin approval first.
3. No organisation — joins our public area for parents, carers and individuals.

Path 1 — Joining an existing organisation

For someone whose school, college, university or employer is already using the platform. The most common path.

How it works

- 1 Open the sign-up page**
The new user goes to the website and clicks **Register** on the sign-in screen.
- 2 Pick the right path**
They choose “**I work for or study at an existing organisation.**”
- 3 Enter their email and password**
Email, name, and a password (10+ characters with mixed case, a number and a symbol). The page checks the password meets the rules as they type.
- 4 Choose their organisation**
Start typing the organisation's name. A list of matching schools and employers appears — they pick theirs from the list.
- 5 Choose their role**
Only roles their organisation has approved (for example Practitioner, Student, Careers Officer) are offered. They pick the one that fits.
- 6 Sign in straight away**
They're taken to the sign-in page with a green confirmation banner. They sign in with the email and password they just chose, and land on their dashboard. **No admin approval needed.**

Why is this safe to auto-approve?

Each organisation has already told the charity which roles they want to allow (Students only, Practitioners only, etc.) — anyone signing up has to fit that list. Org admins can deactivate an account at any time from their admin panel. Sign-up attempts are also rate-limited to stop abuse.

Path 2 — Setting up a new school or business

For a Practitioner, Careers Officer, or Employee whose organisation isn't on the platform yet. They create the organisation and become its first administrator.

How it works

- 1 Open the sign-up page**
Same starting point — the new user clicks **Register**.
- 2 Pick the right path**
They choose “**I want to register a new school or business.**”
- 3 Tell us who they are**
They pick one of three roles: **Practitioner**, **Careers Officer**, or **Employee**. This decides what kind of organisation they can set up — practitioners and careers officers can register a school, college, academy or university; employees can register a business (employer).
- 4 Add the organisation's details**
Organisation name (e.g. "Newpark Academy"), the type, and their own name, email and password.
- 5 Wait for approval**
After submitting, they see a thank-you page explaining the application is being reviewed. The charity admin team will receive the application in their dashboard.
- 6 Charity admin reviews and approves**
An Ambitious about Autism admin opens the pending list, reviews the application, and clicks Approve. Both the new organisation and the applicant's account are activated.
- 7 Sign in**
Once approved, the applicant signs in normally. They land on their **organisation admin dashboard** where they can start adding colleagues, choosing training programmes, and setting up announcements.

Why does this need approval?

Creating a new school or business adds an organisation to the platform — so we want a charity admin to confirm it's a real, recognised organisation before anyone else can join it. Approval is usually quick.

Why limit who can do this?

We only allow Practitioners, Careers Officers and Employees to register new organisations. A student or parent shouldn't be able to spin up a fake school — they'd take Path 1 (joining an existing one) or Path 3 (no organisation) instead.

Path 3 — No organisation (parents, carers, individuals)

For anyone who wants access to the platform but isn't part of a school, college or employer. Parents, carers, autistic adults, supporters, and independent professionals.

How it works

- 1 Open the sign-up page**
Same starting point as the other two paths.
- 2 Pick the right path**
They choose “I don't have an organisation.”
- 3 Tell us a bit about themselves**
They pick the option that describes them best (see the table below). This decides what their account will look like.
- 4 Enter their details**
Name, email and password — same rules as the other paths.
- 5 Sign in straight away**
They're taken to the sign-in page and can sign in immediately. They land in our public area, with access tailored to their role.

The four options

What describes you?	What you'll be on the platform
I am autistic	Student account
I am the parent / carer / relative of an autistic young person	Parent / Carer account
I am a supporter	Parent / Carer account (general follower)
I am a professional working with autistic people	Practitioner account

Why no “employer” option here?

An employer without an organisation isn't really an employer — they're more of a general supporter of the cause. So we've left that option out of this path. Anyone with an actual employer organisation can use Path 2 to register their business; everyone else picks *I am a supporter*.

Special cases

Single Sign-On (SSO)

Some organisations sign in using their own corporate login (Microsoft, Google, etc). When the platform recognises the email address belongs to one of those organisations, the password fields are hidden and a **Sign in with [their organisation]** button appears instead. The user signs in with their existing work account — no new password to remember.

Email already on the platform

If someone tries to register with an email that already has an account, the form gently tells them and links them to the sign-in page.

Password requirements

Same rules across every path: at least 10 characters, with one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one symbol (for example !, @, #, \$). The form shows live feedback as the user types so they can see when their password is strong enough.

Stopping abuse

Each visitor can submit the sign-up form a maximum of 5 times every 15 minutes. This stops anyone from flooding the platform with fake accounts.

Summary

The new sign-up page replaces the current message that tells users to contact their administrator. It's deliberately simple — three paths, one form, and the right outcome for whoever is signing up.

Path	What happens after they submit
Path 1 — Existing organisation	Instant sign-in
Path 2 — New school or business	Charity admin approval, then sign-in
Path 3 — No organisation	Instant sign-in (public area)

What's next?

Once you've reviewed this document we'll build the sign-up page and the supporting pieces that go with it (approval queue updates, the thank-you pages, and the sign-in confirmation banner). Sign-off on this flow is all we need to start.

Prepared for: **Ambitious about Autism**

Document: AAA Self-Registration Flow — Client Handover

Status: For review